

Indian economy is robust and resilient

Trump's "dead economy" jibe gets a **fitting** reply with Modi's vision of India as world's third largest economy

Let us face it. India-US relations are **at their lowest ebb** in the last 20 years or so. Not even at the time of Pokhran-II, when the US had **slapped sanctions** on India, were the relations as bad as they are now. It looks like President Donald Trump has taken steps in **vengeance**, almost trying to punish India for reasons best known to him. Maybe it is India's rising world **stature**, its leadership in **BRICS**, or its growing **proximity** with Russia that Trump **cannot digest**.

One thing is clear. Trump isn't behaving like the friend we all thought he was. Every other day, he is making statements to **embarrass** the Indian Government and India — his "dead economy" jibe is a **case in point**. However, he got an **emphatic rebuttal** from Prime Minister Modi.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi declared that India is **on course to** become the third-largest economy in the world—a future that demands **alertness, resilience**, and economic **self-reliance**. Speaking in Varanasi over the weekend, Modi **underscored** that India's economic **trajectory** remains robust, even **in the face of** external **headwinds** like the recently announced 25 per cent tariffs on Indian goods by the United States. Without naming Trump directly, the Prime Minister's **remarks** were unmistakably a response to the former president's **dismissive** comments about India's economy and threats of further economic penalties. Trump's **criticism** came **in the wake of** India's continued trade relations with Russia, a **geopolitical sore point** for Washington. He **claimed** that India's economy had "**tanked**" and was overly dependent on American markets. Yet, Modi **painted** a different **picture** of a rising India, aware of global **instability** but **determined to chart its own course**. He **minced no words** when he said that there is an **atmosphere** of global instability. India is **set to** become the third biggest economy in the world, and that is why India will have to stay alert **as far as** its economic interests **are concerned**, accepting the challenge thrown by Donald Trump. The **stark contrast** between Trump's alarmist **rhetoric** and Modi's nationalist **optimism reflects** a deeper **downturn** in India-US relations, which have seen a sharp slide in recent months. The **imposition** of **steep tariffs** by Trump **has cast a shadow** over **bilateral** economic **ties** and **reflects** growing **friction** on trade, defence **alignments**, and geopolitical **positioning**. But while the 25 per cent tariffs may hurt Indian exporters, they are **unlikely to derail** the country's broader economic **momentum**.

India's domestic demand remains strong, **infrastructure** investments are **accelerating**, and the Government continues to prioritise sectors like agriculture, manufacturing, and job creation. Modi's renewed **call** to the nation to go "vocal for local" and **embrace** 'swadeshi' goods **is** part of a larger strategic **push** to reduce dependence on imports and build economic **resilience**. Trump's **remarks** may have been designed for a domestic political audience, but they **reflect** an increasingly transactional **tone** in US foreign policy toward India.

New Delhi, in turn, is **repositioning** itself as a **self-reliant** power that will engage globally but on its own terms. India's **economy**, far from being "dead," **is striving to** be **decisively** independent, increasingly **indigenous**, and strategically **assertive**. For India, the message is clear: the **path** to becoming the world's third-largest economy **lies** not in **validation** from others, but in belief in its own capabilities.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

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Vocabulary

1. **Robust** (adjective) – strong, sturdy, vigorous, powerful, tough मज़बूत
2. **Resilient** (adjective) – adaptable, tough, flexible, strong, quick to recover शीघ्र सुधारने वाला
3. **Jibe** (noun) – taunt, insult, sneer, barb, mockery ताना / अपमानजनक टिप्पणी
4. **Fitting** (adjective) – appropriate, suitable, apt, proper, relevant उपयुक्त
5. **At one's lowest ebb** (phrase) – at the worst point, declining, weakest, deteriorating, failing सबसे बुरे दौर में
6. **Slap** (verb) – impose, levy, inflict, charge, enforce थोपना / लागू करना
7. **Sanction** (noun) – restriction, penalty, embargo, prohibition, ban प्रतिबंध
8. **Vengeance** (noun) – revenge, retaliation, retribution, payback, reprisal बदला
9. **Stature** (noun) – reputation, status, standing, prestige, eminence प्रतिष्ठा
10. **BRICS** (noun) – Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa, used especially when talking about the economies of these countries as a group
11. **Proximity** (noun) – closeness, nearness, adjacency, immediacy, intimacy निकटता
12. **Digest** (verb) – accept, tolerate, absorb, endure, bear सहना / पचाना
13. **Embarrass** (verb) – shame, humiliate, discomfort, discredit, mortify शर्मिंदा करना
14. **Case in point** (phrase) – example, illustration, instance, reference, example case उदाहरण
15. **Emphatic** (adjective) – forceful, firm, definite, assertive, vigorous ज़ोरदार / दृढ़
16. **Rebuttal** (noun) – counter, refutation, denial, contradiction, response खंडन
17. **On course to** (phrase) – likely to, heading towards, progressing to, destined for, set to के रास्ते पर
18. **Alertness** (noun) – awareness, attentiveness, vigilance, watchfulness, mindfulness सतर्कता
19. **Resilience** (noun) – toughness, endurance, flexibility, durability, strength मज़बूती
20. **Self-reliance** (noun) – independence, self-sufficiency, autonomy, self-dependence, self-support आत्मनिर्भरता
21. **Underscore** (verb) – emphasize, highlight, stress, underline, point out ज़ोर देना
22. **Trajectory** (noun) – path, course, direction, track, route पथ / प्रगति दिशा

23. **In the face of** (phrase) – despite, in spite of, even with, against, confronting के बावजूद
24. **Headwind** (noun) – obstacle, resistance, challenge, hindrance, setback बाधा / प्रतिकूल स्थिति
25. **Remark** (noun) – comment, observation, statement, note, utterance टिप्पणी
26. **Dismissive** (adjective) – scornful, disdainful, indifferent, contemptuous, disapproving उपेक्षापूर्ण
27. **Criticism** (noun) – disapproval, condemnation, censure, critique, fault-finding आलोचना
28. **In the wake of** (phrase) – following, after, as a result of, in consequence of, subsequent to के परिणामस्वरूप
29. **Geopolitical** (adjective) – relating to global politics, strategic, diplomatic, international-relations based भूराजनीतिक
30. **Sore point** (noun) – sensitive issue, sore subject, controversial matter, grievance, pain point नाज़ुक मुद्दा / दुखती रग
31. **Claim** (verb) – assert, state, declare, maintain, affirm दावा करना
32. **Tank** (verb) – collapse, fall, crash, fail, decline गिरना
33. **Paint a picture** (phrase) – depict, describe, portray, illustrate, present वर्णन करना
34. **Instability** (noun) – unrest, turbulence, uncertainty, volatility, disorder अस्थिरता
35. **Determined** (adjective) – resolute, firm, strong-willed, persistent, unwavering दृढ़ संकल्पित
36. **Chart one's own course** (phrase) – choose own path, decide independently, set direction, follow own way अपना रास्ता खुद तय करना
37. **Mince no words** (phrase) – speak frankly, be blunt, be direct, be honest, say plainly साफ़-साफ़ कहना
38. **Atmosphere** (noun) – environment, mood, ambiance, climate, tone वातावरण
39. **Set** (to) (verb) – ready to, prepared to, about to, likely to, geared to तैयार होना
40. **As far as ————— are concerned** (phrase) – regarding, in relation to, with respect to, pertaining to, when it comes to जहां तक ————— का सवाल है
41. **Stark** (adjective) – clear, sharp, obvious, evident, plain स्पष्ट / तीव्र
42. **Contrast** (noun) – difference, distinction, variation, dissimilarity, divergence विरोधाभास / अंतर

43. **Rhetoric** (noun) – speech, oratory, bombast, expression, talk भाषण शैली
44. **Optimism** (noun) – hope, confidence, positivity, expectancy, assurance आशावाद
45. **Reflect** (verb) – show, indicate, display, represent, reveal दर्शाना
46. **Downturn** (noun) – decline, recession, slump, drop, fall मंदी / गिरावट
47. **Imposition** (noun) – enforcement, application, levying, implementation, burden थोपना
48. **Steep** (adjective) – high, excessive, sharp, extreme, severe अत्यधिक / तेज़
49. **Tariff** (noun) – duty, tax, levy, charge, toll शुल्क
50. **Cast a shadow** (phrase) – overshadow, affect negatively, bring gloom, diminish, darken नकारात्मक प्रभाव डालना
51. **Bilateral** (adjective) – two-sided, mutual, reciprocal, joint, involving two द्विपक्षीय
52. **Ties** (noun) – relations, connections, bonds, links, associations संबंध
53. **Friction** (noun) – conflict, tension, disagreement, dispute, clash मतभेद
54. **Alignment** (noun) – alliance, arrangement, positioning, coordination, agreement सामंजस्य
55. **Positioning** (noun) – placement, strategy, stance, arrangement, orientation स्थिति निर्धारण / स्थान निर्धारण
56. **Unlikely** (adjective) – improbable, doubtful, dubious, questionable, rare अविश्वसनीय
57. **Derail** (verb) – disrupt, obstruct, hinder, ruin, throw off बाधित करना
58. **Momentum** (noun) – drive, thrust, impetus, energy, motion गति
59. **Infrastructure** (noun) – framework, foundation, base, facilities, structure अवसंरचना
60. **Accelerate** (verb) – speed up, hasten, quicken, boost, advance गति बढ़ाना
61. **Embrace** (verb) – adopt, accept, welcome, support, espouse अपनाना
62. **Push** (noun) – effort, drive, thrust, attempt, campaign प्रयास
63. **Tone** (noun) – mood, attitude, style, manner, voice स्वर / शैली
64. **Reposition** (verb) – shift, move, change, realign, adjust पुनःस्थापित करना
65. **Self-reliant** (adjective) – independent, self-sufficient, autonomous, free-standing, self-supported आत्मनिर्भर

66. **Strive** (to) (verb) – try, aim, attempt, endeavour, struggle प्रयास करना / संघर्ष करना

67. **Decisively** (adverb) – firmly, resolutely, determinedly, conclusively, clearly दृढ़ता से

68. **Indigenous** (adjective) – native, local, original, homegrown, aboriginal स्वदेशी

69. **Assertive** (adjective) – confident, forceful, firm, assured, bold आत्मविश्वासी / दृढ़

70. **Lie** (verb) – exist, rest, reside, be situated, remain स्थित होना

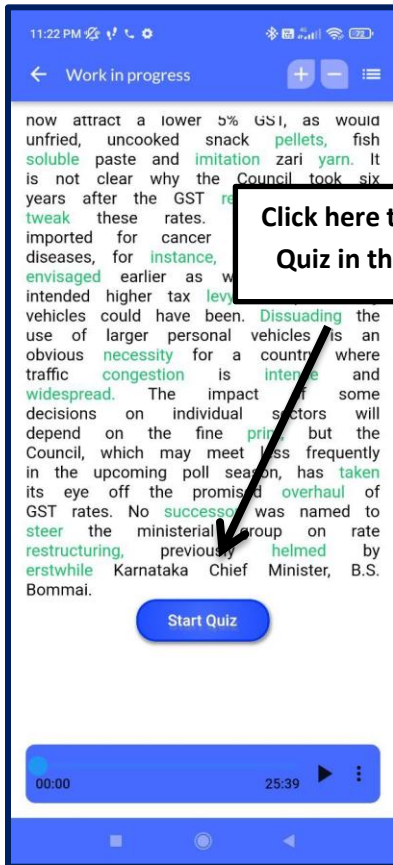
71. **Validation** (noun) – approval, confirmation, recognition, endorsement, authentication मान्यता / पुष्टि

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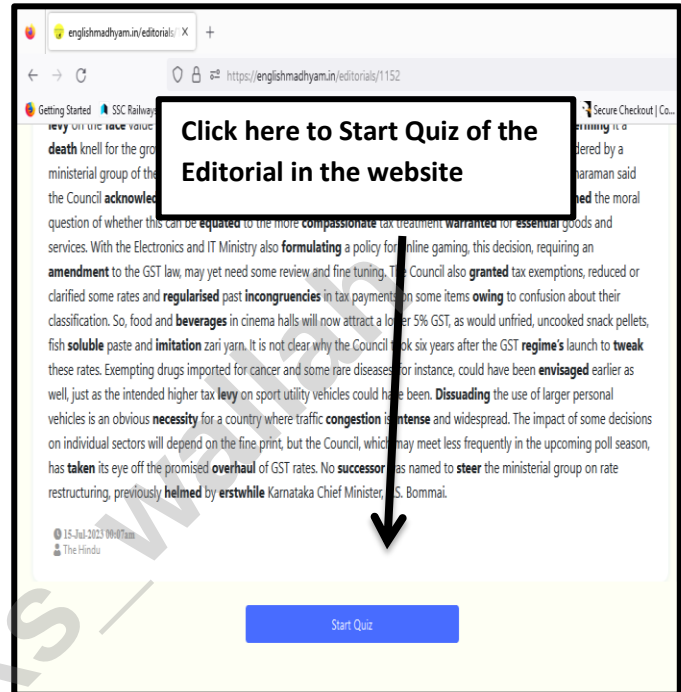
Summary of the Editorial

1. India-US ties have declined sharply, reaching their lowest point in 20 years—worse than even during the Pokhran-II nuclear sanctions.
2. Former US President Donald Trump appears to be acting out of vengeance, possibly due to India's rising global influence, BRICS leadership, and closeness with Russia.
3. Trump's "dead economy" jibe at India is the latest in a series of provocative remarks targeting the Indian government.
4. PM Narendra Modi firmly rebutted Trump's claim, asserting that India is on track to become the third-largest economy globally.
5. Modi highlighted India's resilience and self-reliance, particularly amid global challenges like the 25% US tariffs on Indian goods.
6. Though Modi didn't name Trump, his Varanasi speech was a direct response to Trump's criticism and threats of economic penalties.
7. Trump's comments stem from India's continued trade with Russia, which remains a contentious issue for Washington.
8. Modi acknowledged the current global instability, urging India to stay alert and prioritize national economic interests.
9. There is a clear contrast between Trump's negativity and Modi's confident and nationalist optimism about India's economy.
10. Trump's tariffs reflect growing friction in India-US relations, particularly in trade, defence, and geopolitics.
11. Despite tariffs, India's economic momentum remains strong due to robust domestic demand and infrastructure investments.
12. The government is pushing forward with efforts in agriculture, manufacturing, and job creation to sustain growth.
13. Modi's call to go "vocal for local" and promote swadeshi products aligns with India's strategy for economic independence.
14. Trump's remarks may have domestic political motivations, but they expose a transactional US foreign policy approach toward India.
15. India is redefining itself as a self-reliant global power, determined to succeed on its own terms without relying on external validation.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



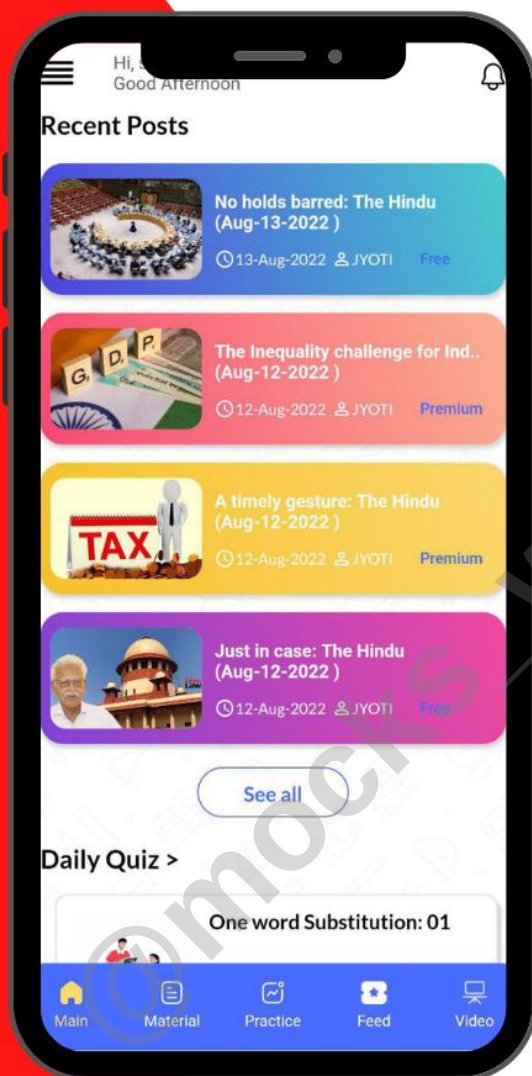
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